

Money no object, we'd all be rolling in 3D printers, albeit while facing some mild discomfort due to the sharp edges and stray 3D prints but rolling in them nevertheless. Since money is the constraint, let's follow the motto of 'if you can't buy it, make it' and make ourselves some 3D printers!

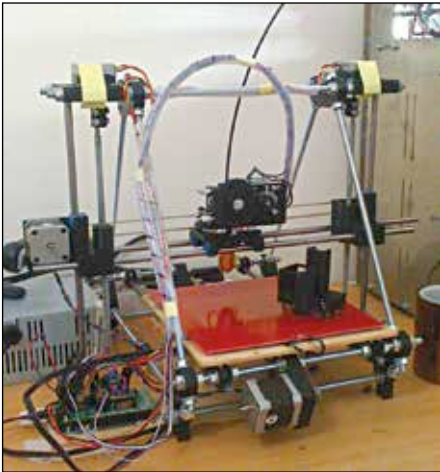
While you can find the used 3D printers online on the cheap and a few models like the OneUp 3D printer available for pre-order for about \$200, for those who do want to make one themselves, we're going to be walking you through the process of making your own 3D printer.

To begin with, you have to understand that there are quite a few different types of 3D printers. You have some (more mainstream) printers that have a heated nozzle and a filament is melted and layered vertically. Others use a powder and a laser melts the particles to create an object and some even harden resins to create the object.

In the interest of simplicity, let's look at the first type we mentioned, which also happens to be rather popular too. FDM or Fused Deposition Modelling is the same technique used by big names like Maker Bot and the wallet friendly open source, DIY names like RepRap as well.

So you want to build your own RepRap 3D Printer.

We're going with RepRap because they're a pioneer when it comes to the world of 3D printing for the masses and have a community base so large that



The RepRap Prusa Mendel

most superlatives would end up not doing enough justice. So if anything goes wrong, one can safely expect a quick, response from somebody who has been there, done that.

The icing on the cake is really the fact that the RepRap can print its own parts and in a way, it can actually pay for itself and replacements parts are going to be a breeze for the ones with enough foresight. If your friends